

Squarespace accessibility cheatsheet

Headings and images. Squarespace 7.1. TrueNorth Accessibility.

Headings

One H1	The page title. Only one per page.
H2 for sections	Main parts of the page.
H3 inside H2	Never skip a level, like H2 to H4.
Set the level	Select text, then Format in the text toolbar. Heading 1 to 4.
Change the look	Use Site Styles. Do not pick a level for its size.
Verify	Test the finished page with WAVE or HeadingsMap. Templates can add headings.

Images: decorative or informative?

Ask: if I remove this image, is anything lost? No means decorative. Yes means informative.

Decorative	Image block: open editor, Content tab, leave Image alt text empty. There is no decorative switch.
Backgrounds	Section backgrounds have no alt field. Use only for decoration. If it carries meaning, use an image block.
Informative	Add Image alt text. Up to 250 characters.
Gallery block	Enter an image title. Falls back to description.
Product image	Alt text field. Falls back to product name.

Writing alt text

Be specific	Who or what, doing what, where.
Keep it short	Aim for under about 125 characters.
No filler	Skip "image of" and "photo of".
Linked image	Describe where it goes, like "Download the 2026 menu (PDF)".
Text in image	Repeat the text exactly.

Weak	IMG_4021.jpg, or "bread"
Better	Baker dusting flour over sourdough loaves in our Portland shop

Before you publish

1. One H1 on the page.
2. No skipped heading levels.
3. No bold text pretending to be a heading.
4. Every informative image has alt text.
5. Decorative images have empty alt text.
6. Tried it with a screen reader or WAVE.